

comes with a white backlight, and the LG G1500 was the only phone with a mild blue backlight. The Alcatel 331 uses an orange backlight. BenQ's M560G gives you the added advantage of changing the backlight to suit your mood. The Philips 330's screen was the best in terms of legibility.

Personal information managers in all phones are a basic affair. However, the Alcatel 331 and the LG 1500 have some additional features that set them apart from the rest.

Nokia's 1100, LG's 1500, and the BenQ 620i and 630i were the only phones that lacked polyphonic ringtones.

Almost all the models had their connectivity options limited to WAP. However, BenQ's M560G offers GPRS capability. It does not support PC connectivity though.

As for the extra frills, Nokia's 1100 is the only phone to have an inbuilt torch, which though handy, is not powerful enough. All BenQ phones have a handsfree speaker. A calculator with a currency or metric converter is common to almost all the phones—what differs is its implementation. The same applies for alarms—you can now set alarms differently for different days.

Nokia showed its mettle when it came to signal reception and

voice clarity. Its signal reception stayed put even in low signal areas and the voice didn't crackle. Almost all the models from BenQ were on par with Nokia's performance in this department. Close on their

heels were the models from Philips, LG and Alcatel. Expect a minimum battery life of 3 days on these phones if you use them for around an hour a day, with a few gaming sessions thrown in.

All said and done, BenQ's M560G is the phone you should look out for if features is your major concern. Its practical usability, small compact body and good set of features are strong points in its favour. However, you can also consider the Nokia 1100, which is equally impressive in its usability aspect. The small difference that lends Nokia an upper hand is the slick and easy-to-use interface that most people are familiar with.

The Philips 330 should appeal to people on a shoe string budget with a flip-phone fetish. The S1160 from Bird is buyable, but the problem is that its competitors have a better product to market.

As for the BenQ mobile gentry, the S620i and S630i look like retired gentlemen. We would rather suggest the M650G—it looks better and has loads of features to play around with.



CATEGORY

BASIC PHONES

Brand	Alcatel	Alcatel	Benq	Benq	Benq	Bird	LG	Nokia	Philips
Model	OneTouch 331	OneTouch 320	M560G	S620i	S630i	S1160	G1500	1100	330
Basic features									
Antenna	Internal	Internal	Internal	External	External	External	Internal	Internal	External
Weight (gms)	77	80	79	80	81	83	85	86	78
Dimensions (mm)	98x42x20	106x45x20	99x42x18	84.9x46x19.2	84.9x46x19.3	85x44x19.6	107x43x22	107x46x20	83x43x22
Network Band support	Dual band	Dual band	Dual band	Dual band	Dual band	Dual band	Dual band	Dual band	Dual band
Rated standby time (hours)	280	120	210	210	210	100	250	400	400
Rated talk time (hours)	6	6	3	3.5	3.5	2	4	4.5	4.5
Display screen									
Type/Resolution (pixels)/No of lines	Mono/96X65 /3	Mono/112x64/2	Mono/NA/3	Mono/98x65/2	Mono/98x65/3	Mono/112x64 /2	Mono/128x64/2	Mono/96x65/3	Mono/101x80/6
Ringtones Type (built-in)/Number	Polyphonic/35	polyphonic/15	Polyphonic/NA	Standard/NA	Standard/NA	Polyphonic/NA	polyphonic/15	Standard/35	Polyphonic/30
No of Contacts in Phone/Fields	250/3	100/3	500/5	100/1	100/1	NA	200/5	50/1	300/8
Call records (received/Dialled/Missed)	10 / 10 / 10	20/20/20	10/10/10	10/10/10	10/10/10	NA	20/20/20	10/10/10	10/10/10
Calendar									
Type of view	None	Monthly	Monthly	None	None	Monthly	Monthly	None	Monthly, weekly
Scheduler	✓	✓	✓	None	None	✓	✓	None	✓
Send note	✗	✓	✓	None	None	✗	✗	None	✗
Miscellaneous features									
Alarm/World Clock	✓/✗	✓/NA	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✗
Calculator/Converter	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✓
FM Radio/Flashlight	✗/✗	✗/✗	✗/✗	✗/✗	✗/✗	✗/✗	✗/✗	✗/✓	✗/✗
WAP/GPRS	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✓	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✗	✓/✗
Games provided/Number	✓/3	✓/3	✓/2	✓/4	✓/4	✓/3	✓/3	✓/2	✓/1
USABILITY									
Pocketability	4	3	3.5	2.5	2.5	3	3.5	3.5	3
Ergonomics	4	3	4	3	3	3	3	4	3.5
Typing speed and ease of use	3.5	2.5	3	3	3	4	4	4.5	3
Signal reception	3	2.5	3.5	3.5	3.5	3	3	4	3
Voice clarity	3.5	2.5	3.5	3.5	3.5	2.5	3	4	3
OVERALL SCORE									
Grand Total	67.51	58.75	70.57	58.82	58.82	58.05	63.1	68.81	63.86
Price	2990	3450	4450	4990	4990	4299	4800	4699	4660
VFM	2.3	1.7	1.5	1.2	1.2	1.4	1.3	1.5	1.4
Grade	A	B	B-	C	C		C	C+	C+